A-A-974A
May 25, 1988
SUPERCEDING
A-A-974
February 14, 1980

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

PORTFOLIO, ENVELOPE, SLIDE FASTENER (ARTIFICIAL LEATHER)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Federal Specification KK-P-001170.

This Commercial Item Description covers artificial leather portfolios with a slide fastener (zipper) going around three sides and is intended to carry papers, prints, or similar documents.

Salient characteristics.

Size. The finished dimensions of the portfolios shall be as follows:

Length - 17.5 inches, plus or minus 1 inch.
(Overall left to right at the center)

Width - 12.5 inches, plus or minus 1 inch.
(Overall bottom to top at center, not including sliding handles)

Thickness - 3.0 inches, minimum.
(Expanded depth while closed, faces flat)

The basic material of the portfolio shall be a fully-lined, stitched, fabric supported vinyl (artificial leather), 20 ounce per square yard (minimum). The base material shall be cotton broken twill, 1.14 yd/lb (maximum); or spun polyester fiber, 3.25 ounces per square yard (minimum) in a 2/1 twill weave. The coated cloth shall have a breaking strength of 120 pounds minimum in each direction when tested in accordance with Test Method 5100, Federal Standard No. 191. The artificial leather shall not crack or tear when function tested as specified.

The color of the portfolio shall be dark brown or black, as specified by the contract or purchase order, conforming to the manufacturer's established commercial product. All trim components and the handles, except metallic pieces, shall be the same color as the artificial leather of the portfolio. All metallic components shall have a bright brass appearance.

FSC 8460

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:11Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

The portfolio shall open on three sides by means of a single slide fastener and shall lie flat when open. The slide fastener shall be composed of metallic teeth and shall be attached to the portfolio by no less than 2 rows of stitching on each tape. The cross breaking strength of the chain shall be a minimum of 75 pounds when tested in accordance with ASTM D 2061, Standard Test Methods for Strength Tests for Zippers. The slide fastener tab shall have a leather thong, 3 inches minimum in length, permanently attached. The slide fastener shall not tear, bind or otherwise fail when function tested as specified.

The portfolio shall have two full length expanding pockets on the inside, one attached to each half of the portfolio. The pockets shall be constructed to hold a legal size pad of paper without binding or any kind of deformation of the pocket or the pad.

The portfolio shall be constructed to withstand the Drop test without tearing, bursting any seams, or permanent deformation, and shall operate as designed afterwards.

The portfolio shall have two sliding (disappearing) handles. The handle color shall match the body of the portfolio. The handles shall be capable of passing the handle test without tearing the supporting fabric and without deforming or detaching from the body of the portfolio.

Additional or better features, which are not specifically prohibited by this CID but are a part of the manufacturer's standard commercial product, shall be included in the portfolios being furnished.

Workmanship. The portfolio shall present a neat, finished appearance both inside and outside and shall exhibit no evidence of sharp, jagged, rough, or other unfinished components. The portfolio shall be free from defects which may affect durability, serviceability and appearance.

Quality assurance provisions:

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements. The contractor is responsible for insuring that components and materials used were manufactured, examined, and tested in accordance with referenced specifications and standards.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:11Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Sampling. Unless otherwise specified, finished portfolios shall be sampled and inspected in accordance with MIL-STD-105 for conformance to the construction, dimensions, workmanship and testing requirements herein. A lot shall be all portfolios submitted for inspection at one time, a sample unit shall be one complete portfolio. Any failure of any test shall fail the sample. Three portfolios from each lot shall be subjected to the drop test. Any failure of the drop test shall be grounds for rejection of the lot.

Dimensional examination. The portfolios shall be examined for defects in dimensions. The length and width dimensions shall be determined by measurements made on the outside of the portfolio. The expansion shall be measured on the outside of the portfolio between the outer faces, at the center point of each face equal distance from all outer edges, with the faces of the portfolio lying flat. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the acceptable quality level (AQL) 6.5 percent defective.

Visual inspection. The portfolios shall be examined for defects in color, material and workmanship as specified in Table I. The inspection level shall be S-3 with an AQL of 2.5 defects per hundred units for major defects and 6.5 defects per hundred units for total defects.

TABLE I. Visual examination.

Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Body material	Color not as specified.	X	
	Color of trim not matching body		X
	Color not uniform, seriously affecting appearance.	X	
	Color not uniform, affecting appearance but not seriously.		X
Quality of body material	Any hole, cut or rupture.	X	
	Any of the following imperfections present to a degree where the condition will have an affect on serviceability or appearance:		
	Uncoated, thinly coated, separation of coating (including at stitched edges), cracked coating, blisters, wrinkles, indistinct grain, or tackiness of artificial leather.		
	Serious affect,	X	
	Affect, but not serious,		X

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:11Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Table I, (Cont.)

Slide fastener	Any part of assembly omitted, bent, broken, cracked or otherwise defective.	X	
	Teeth not metallic.	X	
	Pull tab or thong omitted.	X	
	Tape stitched too close to metal chain not permitting slider to pass freely.		X
	Ends of fastener not secured		X
Construction and Workmanship	Any component part or required operation omitted.	X	
	Any part fractured, ripped, torn, punctured, malformed, or otherwise damaged seriously affecting serviceability.	X	
	Any component misplaced or assembly malformed seriously affecting serviceability.	X	
	Any component misplaced or assembly malformed affecting serviceability, but not seriously.		X
Seams and stitching	Loose stitch tension resulting in a loosely secured seam.	X	
	More than three continuous stitch locks exposed on surface of body material, but seam is tight.		X
	More than two continuous needle holes visible as a result of removal of threads.		X
	Thread ends not trimmed.		X
	Open seam.	X	

Note: A seam shall be classified as open when one or more stitches joining a seam are broken or when two or more consecutive skipped stitches or run-offs occur.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:11Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Tests.

Certificate of Conformance. When specified, a certificate of conformance to the test requirements may be acceptable in lieu of testing each lot. The contractor shall have available for review evidence that those tests specified herein have been performed, that the product tested conformed with the requirements of this CID, and that the product being offered has been manufactured using the same materials, processes, and manufacturing techniques, and is otherwise identical to the product tested. This certificate of conformance shall not be more than 1 year old as of the effective date of the contract.

Sampling. The inspection level for the specified tests shall be S-1 unless otherwise specified. The failure of any sample tested shall constitute failure of the lot.

Test conditions. Unless otherwise specified the test apparatus may be of any design suitable for performance of the test. The function test and slide fastener test shall be conducted at 68 to 75 degrees Fahrenheit and 48 to 52 percent relative humidity. The portfolios for the handle test and drop test shall be loaded and conditioned at minus 10 plus or minus 5 degrees Fahrenheit, for a minimum of 4 hours in a refrigerated cabinet or chamber and then be tested immediately after removal from the cabinet or chamber.

Handle test. The sample portfolios shall be fully opened and hung over a rod in such a manner that the handles hang down and swing freely. A 75 pound weight (plus or minus 3 pounds) shall be evenly distributed over both handles together for 30 minutes. After the test the portfolios shall be examined. Any tears in the supporting fabric or body of the portfolio or evidence of deformation or separation of the handle shall fail the sample.

Drop test. Each portfolio shall be filled with pillows or bags, loaded with sand or vermiculite or some similar substances, to attain the test loads and, at the same time, completely fill the interior of the portfolio to avoid secondary impact due to shifting of the test load. The net load shall be 6.0 pounds (plus or minus 0.25 pounds). The weight shall be evenly distributed and the slide fastener shall be completely closed during the test. The weighted portfolio shall then be dropped 15 times to a concrete floor from a height of 24 inches (plus or minus 0.5 inches, measured from the lowest point of the portfolio) as follows: 5 times so that it lands on the end opposite the handles, 5 times so that it lands on one side end and 5 times so that it lands on the opposing side end. Upon completion of the test, the portfolio shall be examined to insure that none of the components are cracked, torn, fractured, perforated, loosened or deformed to the extent that the portfolio is inoperable. If the portfolio is in any way inoperable or if there are tears in the fabric, separation of the seams or permanent deformation of the body or slide fastener the sample shall fail. Cosmetic imperfections, resulting from the drops, shall not be considered defects.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:11Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Function test. Two samples from each lot shall be subjected to this test. A closed portfolio shall be unzipped, opened fully to lie flat, and then re-zipped to close completely for 5,000 cycles. The above procedure shall be considered one cycle when tested in the sequence cited. Upon completion of the test, the case shall be examined to insure that none of the components are cracked, fractured, loosened or deformed to the extent that the case is inoperable. The slide fastener shall remain operable at the end of the test with no appreciable increase in operating force.

Slide fastener strength test. The cross breaking strength of the chain shall be tested using ASTM D 2061. Any failure at less than 75 pounds shall constitute failure of the test.

Inspection for preparation and delivery. An inspection shall be made to determine whether the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements of the contract or purchase order. Examination for defects shall be in accordance with table II. For examination of interior packaging, the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE II
Preparation for delivery defects.

Examine	Defects
Markings	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Material	Any component missing, damaged, or not conforming to applicable requirements stated herein.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, or distortion of container.
Contents	Quantity of container is more or less than required. Gross weight exceeds requirements of the box specification.

Regulatory requirements. In accordance with section 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulations, the Governments policy is to acquire items composed of the highest percentage of recovered materials practicable, consistent with maintaining a satisfactory level of competition without adversely affecting performance requirements or exposing employees to undue hazards from the recovered materials.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:11Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Packing, packaging, and marking. The packing, packaging, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

Notes:

Federal Standards are available from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston, MA; New York, NY; Philadelphia, PA; Washington, DC; Atlanta, GA; Chicago, IL; Kansas City, MO; Fort Worth, TX; Denver, CO; San Francisco, CA; Los Angeles, CA; and Seattle, WA.

Military Standards are available from the Naval Publications and Forms Center, 5801 Tabor Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19120.

Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted here and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this CID.
(b) Color of the portfolio (black or dark brown).
(c) Packaging and packing required.
(d) Markings required.

Reference NSN - 8460-01-070-7517 Color - Brown

MILITARY INTERESTS:
NONE: DoD has determined that no military activity has an official interest in this Commercial Item Description.

Preparing Activity:

GSA-FSS

Civilian Coordinating Activities:

VA - OSS
FAA - 48

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:11Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.